



Enhancing Apple TV+ User Experience

Presented by:

- Nitish Chowdary Kolupoti
- Divya Teja Mannava
- Taranjot Singh Dang
- Ayushi Ghia

Course: User Experience Design / Testing — Instructor: Vishal Chawla.

A concise plan to improve discoverability, personalization, and family safety on Apple TV+.

Project Introduction



About

Redesigning Apple TV+ to enhance content discovery, personalization, and family safety through improved navigation and AI-driven features.



Project Type

- Academic Project
- Course: User Experience Design / Testing
- Institution: Northeastern University



Tools Used

- Figma (High-fidelity design & prototyping)
- Balsamiq (Wireframing)
- Google Forms (User research)
- SWOT Analysis & Card Sorting



Duration

- October 2025 - December 2025
- 8 weeks



Team Responsibilities

- Divya Teja Mannava: Use cases, Onboarding flow, AI integration
- Nitish Chowdary Kolupoti: User research, Personas, Storyboarding
- Taranjot Singh Dang: Information Architecture, Design System, High-fidelity prototyping
- Ayushi Ghia: SWOT analysis, Wireframes, Subscription flow

Problem Statement

Apple TV+ currently presents several usability challenges that negatively affect user satisfaction and engagement. The platform suffers from **complex navigation, limited engagement features, an unclear subscription process, and minimal personalization**. The absence of comprehensive filtering options makes **content discovery slow and inefficient**, while the lack of **multi-user profiles** results in shared viewing histories and non-personalized recommendations.

- ❏ Furthermore, **no interactive previews or effective watchlist management system** diminishes user engagement. The **absence of a dedicated Kids Profile with parental controls** leads to inappropriate content recommendations for children. Collectively, these factors contribute to a fragmented, less enjoyable viewing experience.



Current UX Breakdown

A structured view of problems and user impact highlights priorities for design and research.

Filtering Options	Limited — users take too long to find shows and movies.
User Profiles	Single shared account — mixed histories and poor personalization.
Smart Recommendations	No AI preference learning — generic suggestions lower engagement.
Subscription & Billing	Unclear pricing and bundles — new users confused during sign-up.
Parental Controls	No dedicated Kids Profile — risk of inappropriate recommendations.



OUR SOLUTION

A comprehensive Apple TV+ redesign that transforms the streaming experience through intelligent personalization, family-centric features, and effortless content discovery.

AI-Powered Family Profiles

Unlike Netflix's basic profiles, we introduce context-aware AI that adapts recommendations based on time of day, device, and family member—automatically suggesting cartoons at breakfast, movies at night.

Zero-Friction Discovery

Hover previews + advanced filtering eliminate endless scrolling. Find content in 3 clicks vs. industry average of 8-12 clicks.

Trust-First Kids Experience

PIN-protected profiles with age-adaptive content filters that grow with your child—not just binary 'kids mode' like competitors.

Transparent Subscription Journey

Visual plan comparison with no hidden fees—addressing #1 user complaint about streaming platforms.



Result: Personalized, safe, and intuitive streaming that respects both user time and family values.

Core Product Objectives



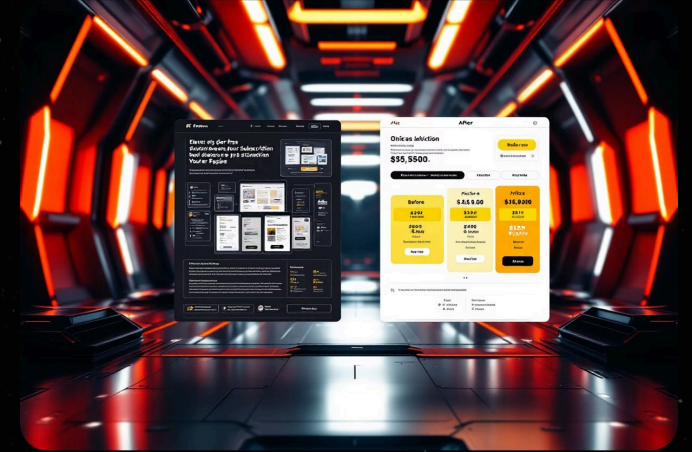
Simplify Navigation

Intuitive menus, consistent taxonomy, and advanced filtering to reduce browsing time. This includes clear categories, a prominent search bar, and easily accessible filters for genre, year, and parental ratings.



Boost Engagement

Interactive previews, seamless watchlist controls, and frictionless playback cues to increase retention. Users will see short video previews when hovering over content, and can easily add items to their watchlist with a single click, promoting continuous discovery.



Clarify Subscriptions

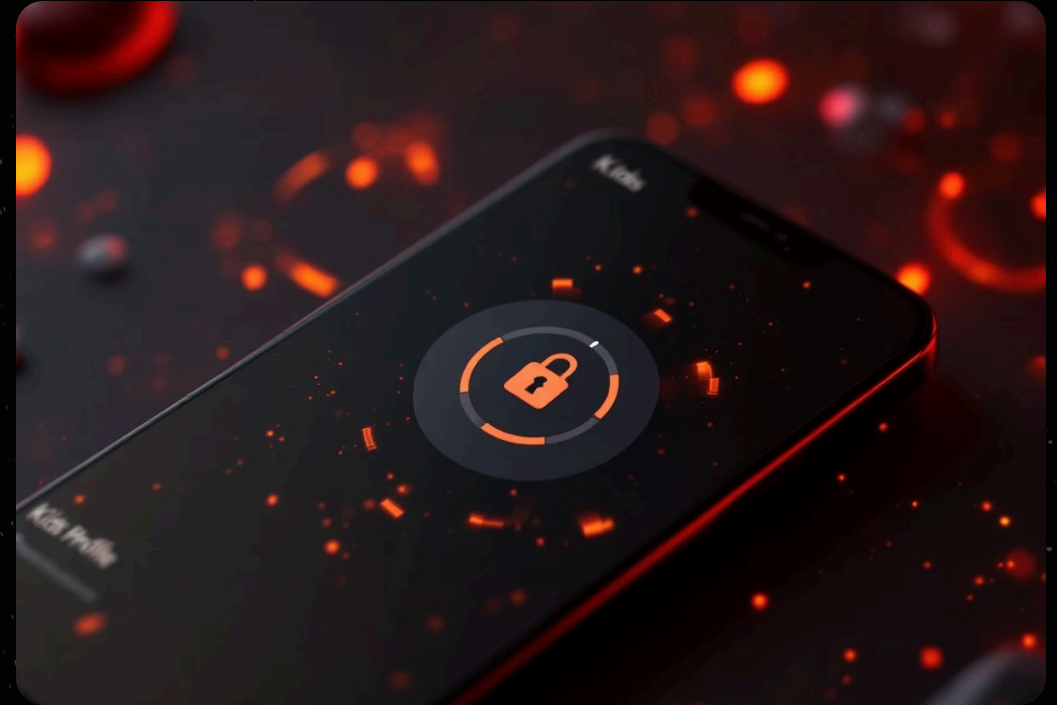
Transparent pricing, plan comparisons, and guided sign-up flows for clearer conversion paths. This will involve a redesigned subscription page that clearly outlines features, pricing tiers, and a simple, step-by-step sign-up process.

Advanced Product Objectives



Personalization

Multi-user profiles with AI-driven recommendations tailored to individual tastes. Each user profile will learn viewing habits to suggest highly relevant content, enhancing the overall user experience and content discovery.



Kids Profile

PIN-protected child profiles, age-based filters, and curated kids-home screens for family safety. This feature ensures children only access age-appropriate content in a secure environment, giving parents peace of mind.

Target Audience



Families: Adults 25-45 yrs | Children 4-12 yrs

Shared accounts across age groups. Primary need: distinct profiles, parental controls, safe recommendations for kids.



Movie Buffs: 18-35 yrs

Frequent, genre-driven viewers. Primary need: intelligent filtering, quick access to new releases and curated collections.



Casual Viewers: 35-60 yrs

Occasional users who prioritize simplicity. Primary need: intuitive, low-friction interface for relaxed browsing.



User Needs

What Apple TV+ Users Expect Today



Seamless Navigation & Discovery

Intuitive interface with quick filters by genre, rating, and year.



Personalization & Smart Recommendations

AI-driven recommendations based on individual viewing habits.



Family Profiles & Parental Controls

Distinct profiles for each family member with secure parental controls.



Streamlined Subscription Flow

Clear pricing, easy plan comparison, and flexible upgrade options.



Quick Access to Favorites

Redesigned Watchlist for instant resume viewing of preferred content.



Cross-Device Continuity

Synchronized playback and preferences across all devices (TV, phone, tablet).



AI-Powered Previews & Search

Interactive hover previews and intelligent conversational search capabilities.

Key User Pain Points



Difficult Navigation

Disorganized layout and hard-to-find content.



Poor Search & Filtering

Slows discovery and leads to frustration.



Unclear Subscriptions

Pricing and plan options are confusing for new users.



Limited Personalization

Shared accounts prevent tailored recommendations.



Overcrowded UI

Forces excessive scrolling and visual fatigue.



Ineffective History Use

Browsing history not leveraged for relevance.



These pain points can compound, creating a frustrating user journey. The current interface often leaves users feeling overwhelmed and unable to easily find what they want.

User Personas

Understanding Our Target Users

Persona 1: The Family Viewer - Priya Sharma

35, Marketing Manager from London

Goals:

- Safe and appropriate content for her children.
- Seamless profile switching between adult and child accounts.
- AI-assisted content curation that aligns with family values.

Pain Points:

- Inappropriate recommendations appearing in family profiles.
- Lack of shared viewing controls or synchronized playback.
- Difficulty finding new, educational content for her kids.

Needs:

- Robust parental controls with customizable restrictions.
- Dedicated and personalized kids' sections.
- Intuitive multi-profile management.

"I just want to relax and enjoy a show with my family without constantly worrying about what might pop up next or endlessly searching for something everyone agrees on."



Persona 2: The Movie Enthusiast - Alex Parker

27, Graduate Student in Film Studies from Manchester

Goals:

- Discover hidden gems and critically acclaimed content.
- Wants deep search filters for IMDb rating and release year.

Pain Points:

- Limited by generic recommendations.
- Cluttered and slow interface.

Needs:

- AI-driven recommendations based on genre mood and ratings.
- Hover previews.

"I love exploring new stories, but I don't have time to scroll endlessly to find something good."



Persona 3: The Casual Viewer - James Wilson

42, Software Engineer from Birmingham

Goals:

- Simple interface with minimal effort to continue watching.
- Wants quick resumption across devices.

Pain Points:

- Gets frustrated by long loading and repetitive suggestions.

Needs:

- "Continue Watching" sync across all devices.
- Clean minimal layout for faster decision-making.

"When I open the app, I just want to pick up right where I left off."





User Research Plan

A focused research approach to validate hypotheses and guide product decisions.



Closed Card Sorting

Purpose: Optimize information architecture.

Insight: Intuitive menu groups and labeling for faster browsing.



Storyboarding

Purpose: Map real-world viewing contexts.

Insight: Emotional pain points and moments to delight (e.g., discoverability moments).



SWOT Analysis

Purpose: Benchmark vs. Netflix, Disney+, Prime.

Insight: Competitive opportunities for personalization and family features.

Closed Card Sorting for AppleTV+

Genres

Subscription

Content

Watch Experience

Accessibility

Parental Controls

Action

Trial

Originals

Watchlist

Subtitles

Age

Comedy

Subscription

Latest

Continue

Dolby

Drama

Rent/Buy

Movies

Next

Kids

TV Shows

History

Exclusives

Recommendations

Storyboard 1

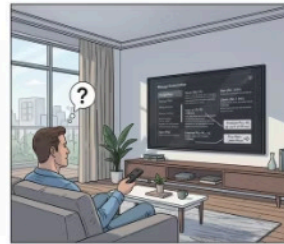


Storyboard 1 – Simplifying Subscription & Plan Management

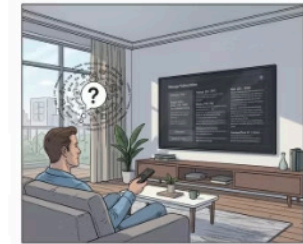
David Upgrades His Plan Seamlessly



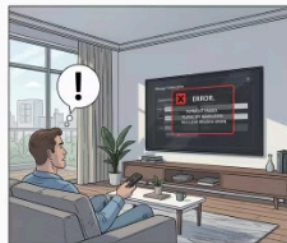
Context: David, an existing Apple TV+ subscriber, sits in his living room trying to upgrade his plan.



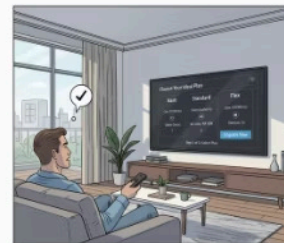
Trigger: He navigates to the subscription section but finds multiple unclear pricing options.



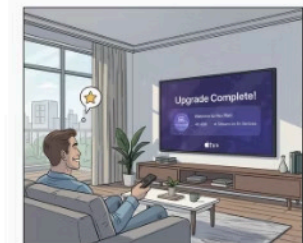
Problem: The comparison layout is text-heavy and lacks clarity. David feels uncertain.



Action: He proceeds but encounters a payment failure with no clear retry guidance.



Solution: A new visual comparison grid and guided checkout clearly show features, pricing, and progress.



Outcome: David upgrades successfully; a confirmation animation reassures him his new plan is active.

Storyboard 2



Storyboard 2 – Personalized Recommendations & Watchlist

Sarah Discovers Her Next Favorite Show Effortlessly



Context: Sarah logs into Apple TV+ after finishing her last series.



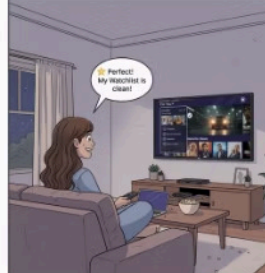
Trigger: She scrolls through generic trending lists and feels lost.



Problem: No personalization; repetitive suggestions waste her time.



Action: She manually searches for titles and tries to manage an outdated watchlist.



Solution: A new “For You” section appears, powered by AI, with hover previews and a single-click watchlist button.



Outcome: Sarah finds relevant new content quickly and feels more connected to her preferences.

Storyboard 3



Storyboard 3 – Kids Profile & Parental Control

Family-Friendly Streaming with Peace of Mind



Context: David's young child accidentally opens the family account.



Trigger: The child sees thumbnails for mature content.



Problem: No restriction or parental lock appears.



Action: David opens settings to search for safety controls.



Solution: A new Kids Profile setup with PIN protection and age-based filters is introduced.



Outcome: The child now enjoys a bright, safe kids' interface, while David feels reassured.

SWOT Analysis AppleTV+ UI

STRENGTHS

High-Quality streaming,
Sleek and minimal UI,
Offline Viewing,
Seamless Ecosystem,
High-Budget Originals

SW

WEAKNESSES

Single subscription
model, Poor Content
discovery, Lack of multi
user profiles, Slow UI
updates

OPPORTUNITIES

User Profile, Watchlist
sharing, AI-driven
recommendations,
Subscription plans,
Watchlist, Voice Bot

OT

THREATS

Strong Competition,
Subscription fatigue, High-
Dependency on Apple
ecosystem, Piracy, Ad-
supported platforms growing

Use Cases

Middleweight Use Cases

Middleweight Use Case 1: Subscription and Plan Management

Actor: David (Customer)

Trigger: Wishes to upgrade from the Basic Plan to the Flex Plan.

Preconditions:

- User is an active subscriber.
- Subscription upgrades are permitted.

Basic Flow:

1. David navigates to Account Settings → Manage Subscription.
2. He selects the Flex Plan (\$14.99/month).
3. Enters updated payment information and confirms.
4. System displays a confirmation message.

Alternate Flow (Payment Failure):

- System prompts to retry or update payment details.
- If retries fail, the user remains on the current plan.

Postconditions:

- Upgrade completes successfully.
- Additional features (e.g., 4K HDR, multi-device streaming) become available.

Heavyweight Use Cases

Heavyweight Use Case 1: Multi-User Profiles and Parental Controls

Actor: David (Parent)

Trigger: A child accesses inappropriate suggestions via an adult profile.

Preconditions:

- Multiple profiles exist under one account.
- Profile PIN protection is enabled.

Basic Flow:

1. David switches to the child's profile.
2. When the child attempts to access an adult profile, a PIN prompt appears.
3. Only correct PIN entry allows access; otherwise, the child remains in the kids' profile.

Postconditions:

- Children view only age-appropriate content.
- Adult profiles remain secure and private.

Middleweight Use Case 2: Personalized Recommendations

Actor: Sarah (Customer)

Trigger: Logs in and seeks new content to watch.

Preconditions:

- Sarah has a viewing history.
- Recommendation system is active.

Basic Flow:

1. Sarah opens Apple TV+.
2. The home screen displays a "For You" section.
3. Hovering over a title shows quick details.
4. She adds selected content to her Watchlist.

Alternate Flow (No Suitable Recommendations):

- The system presents trending or manually searchable titles.

Postconditions:

- Sarah receives relevant suggestions aligned with her interests.
- Watchlist updates with newly selected titles.

Heavyweight Use Case 2: Enhanced Watchlist Management

Actor: Sarah (User)

Trigger: Manages her personal Watchlist.

Preconditions:

- Dedicated Watchlist section exists on the homepage.
- Four favorite titles were added during profile setup.

Basic Flow:

1. Sarah logs into her account.
2. Navigates to Watchlist and removes a completed show.
3. Adds a new title or explores recommended alternatives.

Alternate Flow (Content Unavailable):

- System alerts user that a title is no longer available.
- Suggests similar shows for substitution.

Postconditions:

- Sarah maintains an updated, dynamic Watchlist.
- Personalized recommendations refresh automatically.

Design Process

Following the Double Diamond Framework



PHASE 1 - DISCOVER

Timeline: Week 1-2

Our Activities:

- Competitor analysis (Netflix, Disney+, Prime Video)
- User interviews with 15 streaming users
- SWOT analysis of current Apple TV+
- Pain point identification

Deliverables:

- ✓ 3 User personas
- ✓ Key pain points list
- ✓ Opportunity areas

PHASE 3 - DEVELOP

Timeline: Week 2-3

Our Activities:

- Low-fidelity wireframes (3 key screens)
- Design system creation
- High-fidelity mockups in Figma
- Interactive prototype with transitions

Deliverables:

- ✓ 40+ screen designs
- ✓ Complete design system
- ✓ Clickable prototype

PHASE 2 - DEFINE

Timeline: Week 1-2

Our Activities:

- Closed card sorting (18 participants)
- Storyboarding user journeys
- Use case definition
- Feature prioritization (MoSCoW)

Deliverables:

- ✓ Problem statement
- ✓ Information architecture
- ✓ User needs hierarchy

PHASE 4 - DELIVER

Timeline: Week 2-3

Our Activities:

- Usability testing (10 users)
- Heuristic evaluation
- Accessibility audit (WCAG 2.1)
- Final refinements

Deliverables:

- ✓ Tested prototype
- ✓ Design documentation
- ✓ Handoff-ready files

📌💡 Iterative Process: We cycled back to 'Develop' phase twice based on user feedback, refining navigation and Kids Profile PIN flow.

Moscow Approach

The MoSCoW framework was used to prioritize features based on user impact and feasibility.

1

Must Have

- Personalized home screen
- Clear content categorization
- Watchlist functionality
- Kids-safe content environment

2

Should Have

- Improved search and filtering
- Continue Watching section
- Profile-based recommendations

3

Could Have

- Voice-based navigation improvements
- Smart content suggestions based on time of day
- Enhanced preview interactions

4

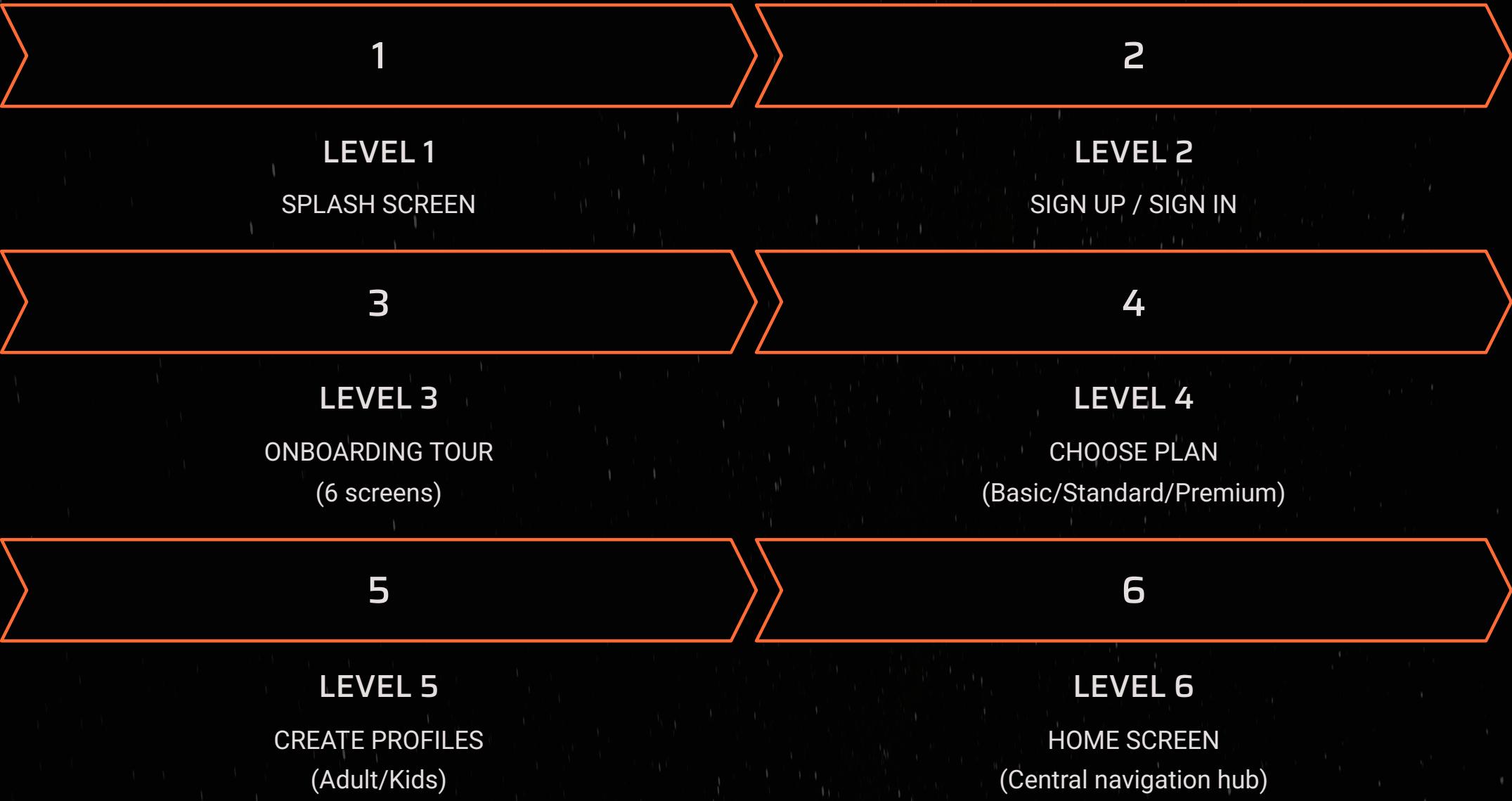
Won't Have (Current Scope)

- Social sharing features
- In-app purchases
- Advanced parental analytics

Information Architecture

Organizing Content for Intuitive Navigation

This sitemap illustrates the hierarchical navigation structure for the Apple TV+ redesign, guiding users from initial access to content discovery and management.



LEVEL 7: Main Features

SEARCH

Filters (Genre, Year, Rating)

MOVIE DETAILS

Play Movie

WATCHLIST

Manage List

PROFILE

Switch Profile, Edit Settings

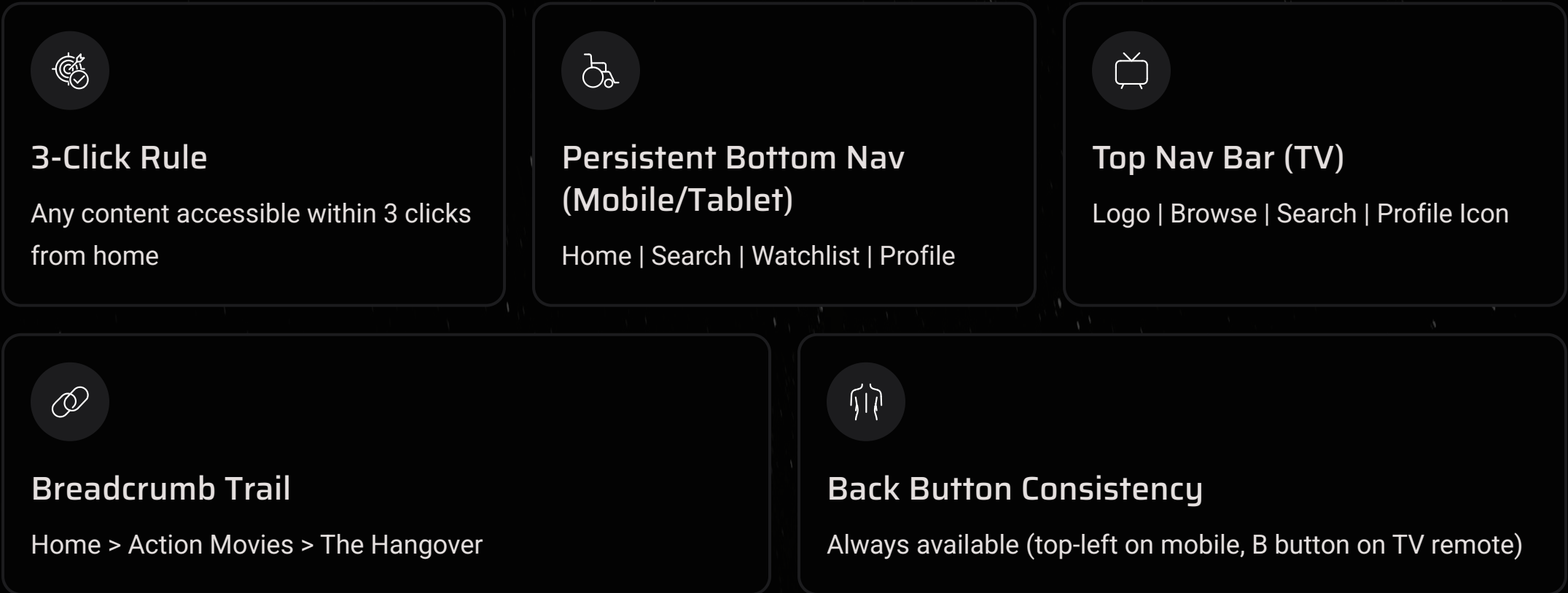
SETTINGS

Subscription Management, Payment

MY LIST

Continue Watching

Key Navigation Principles



Onboarding Process

Setting the Foundation for User Success



Welcome & Introduction

A warm greeting highlighting key benefits like AI recommendations, multi-profile support, and watchlist access.



Sign In / Create Account

Secure Apple ID login or new account creation with robust two-factor authentication.



Choose a Subscription Plan

Transparent comparison of Basic, Standard, and Premium plans with clear pricing and features.



Set Up User Profiles

Create multiple profiles with names, avatars, age preferences, including Kids Profile PIN protection.



Select Favorite Genres

Enhance AI personalization by selecting 3-5 preferred genres for tailored recommendations.



Explore & Personalize

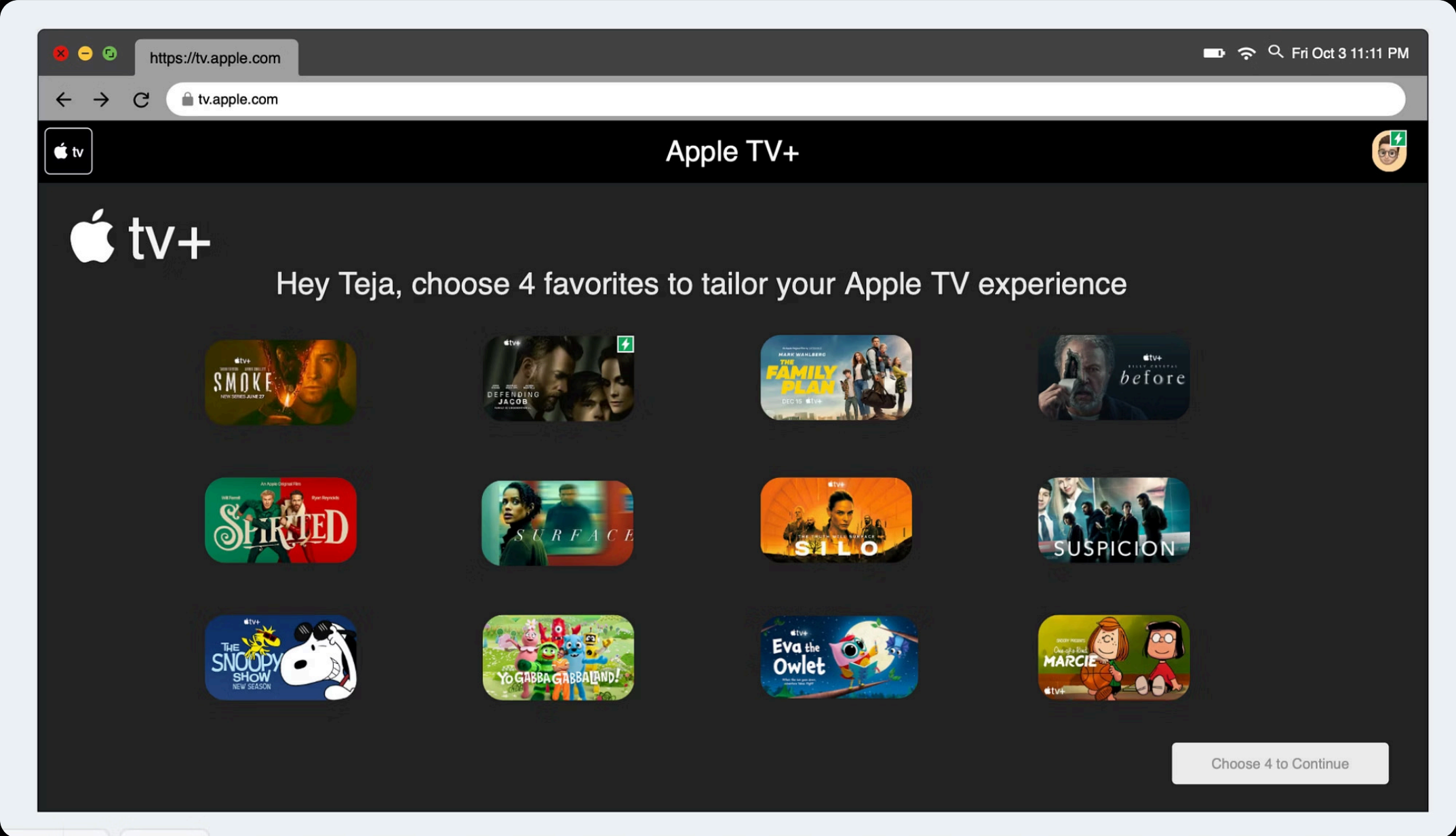
Discover a curated home screen with helpful tooltips for new features like hover preview, watchlist, and smart search.



Continuous Personalization

Experience ongoing system refinement, adapting recommendations and content based on your evolving preferences.

Wireframe 1 — Favorite Shows Selection (Low-Fidelity Mocqup)



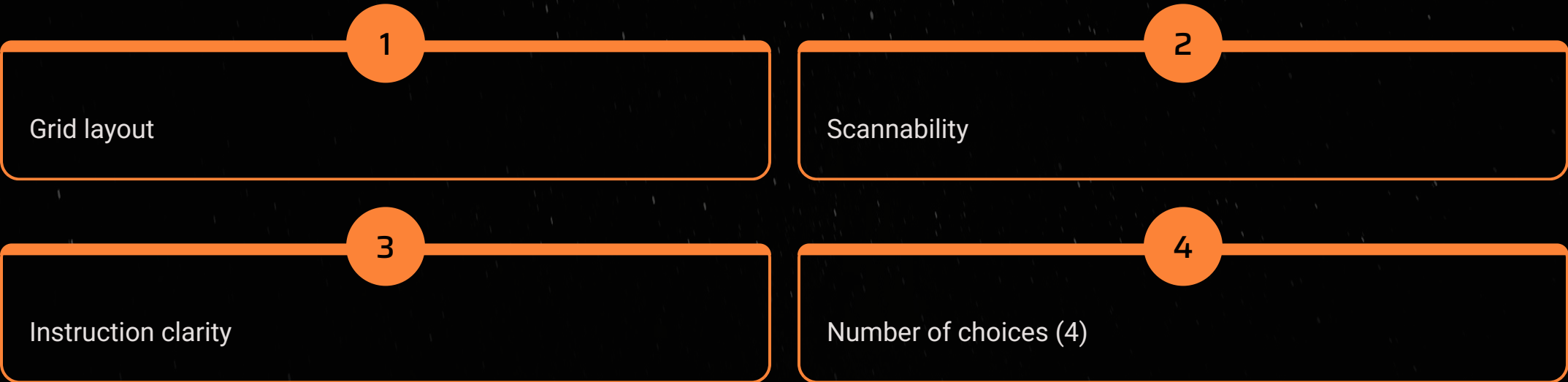
This wireframe represents the early onboarding step where users select 4 favorite shows to personalize recommendations.

The goal was to test layout structure, card spacing, and instruction clarity without focusing on visuals.

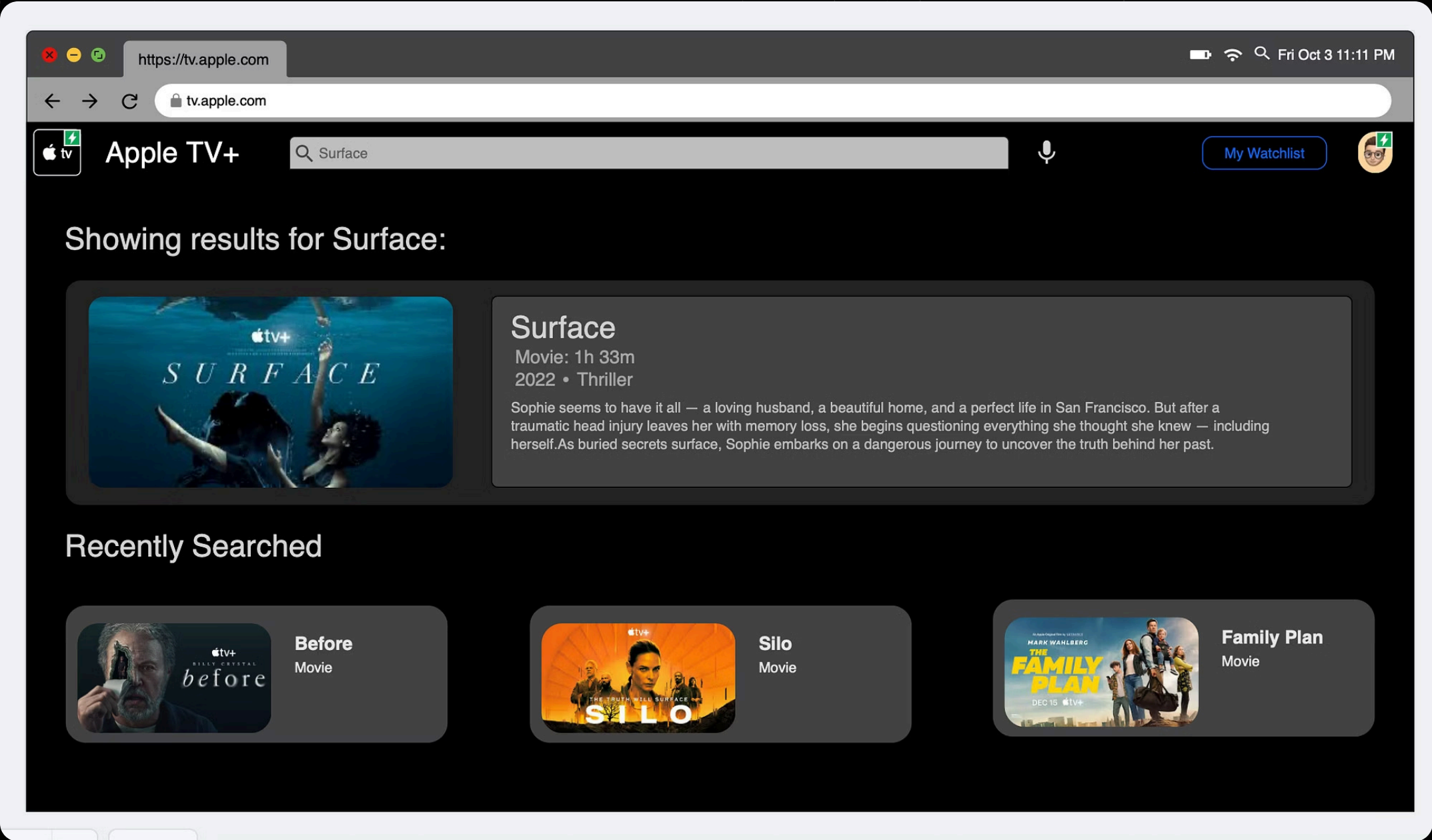
Using simple placeholders allowed quick iteration and feedback on whether users understood the selection requirement.

Early insights showed that users appreciated the grid but wanted clearer highlighting when a show was selected.

Key Focus Areas:



Wireframe 2 — Genre Preferences (Low-Fidelity Mocqup)



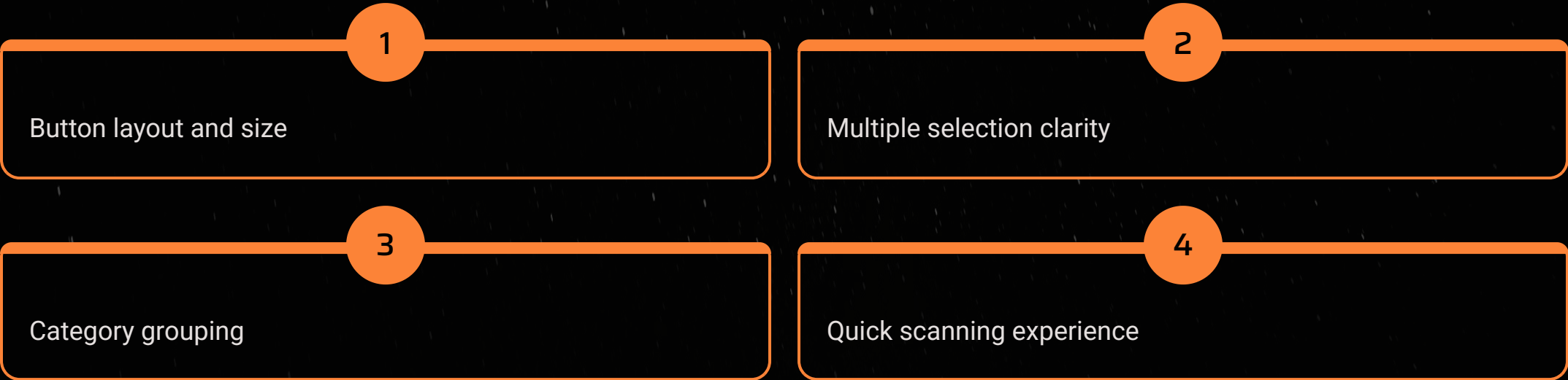
This wireframe visualizes the second onboarding step, where users choose categories they enjoy watching.

Basic color blocks were intentionally used as placeholders to test button size, spacing, and grouping.

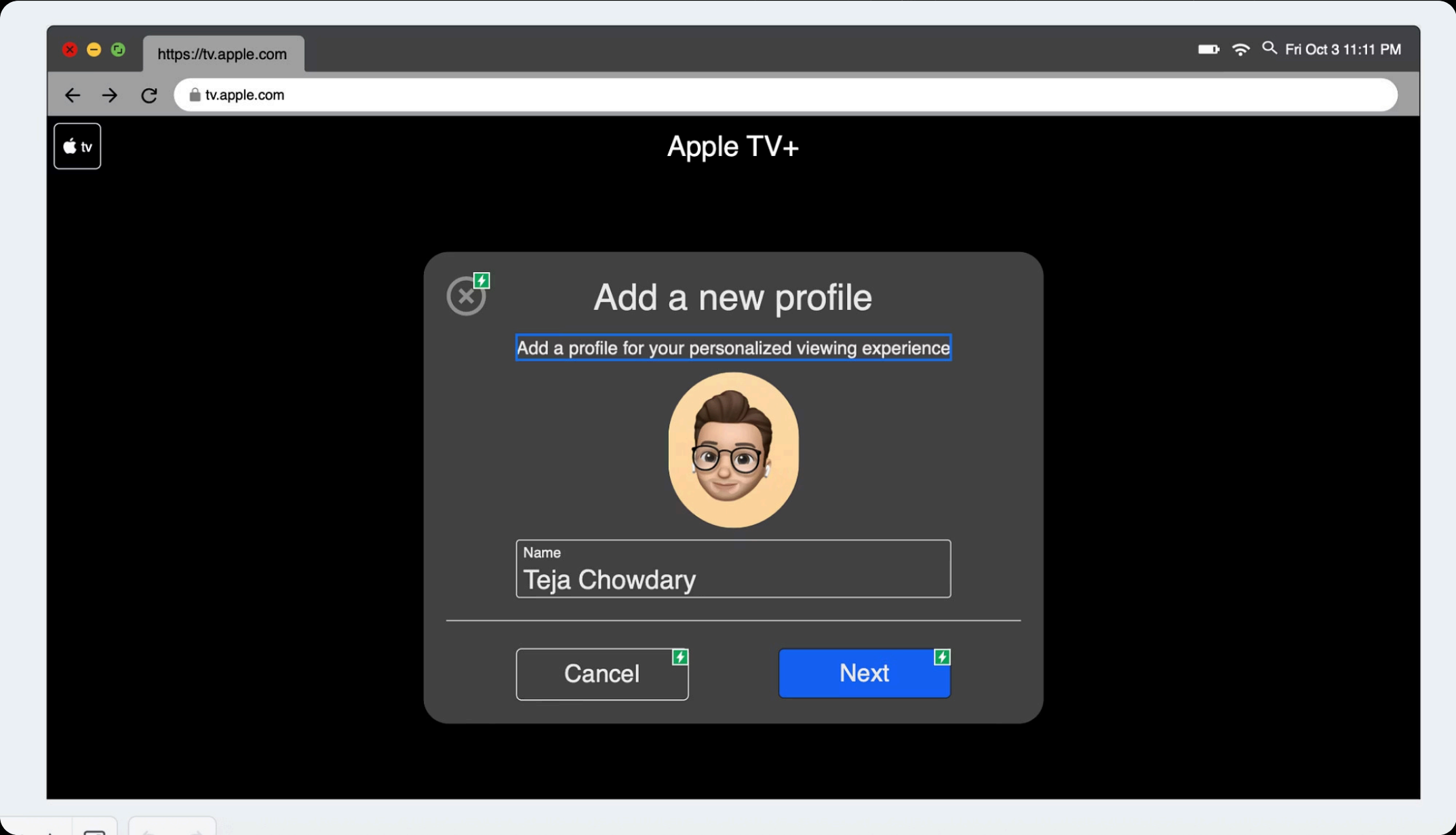
The primary goal was to validate whether users could quickly identify categories and understand that multiple selections were allowed.

Feedback suggested improving category grouping and adjusting spacing for better readability in the final design.

Key Focus Areas:



Wireframe 3 — Add a New Profile (Low-Fidelity Mocqup)



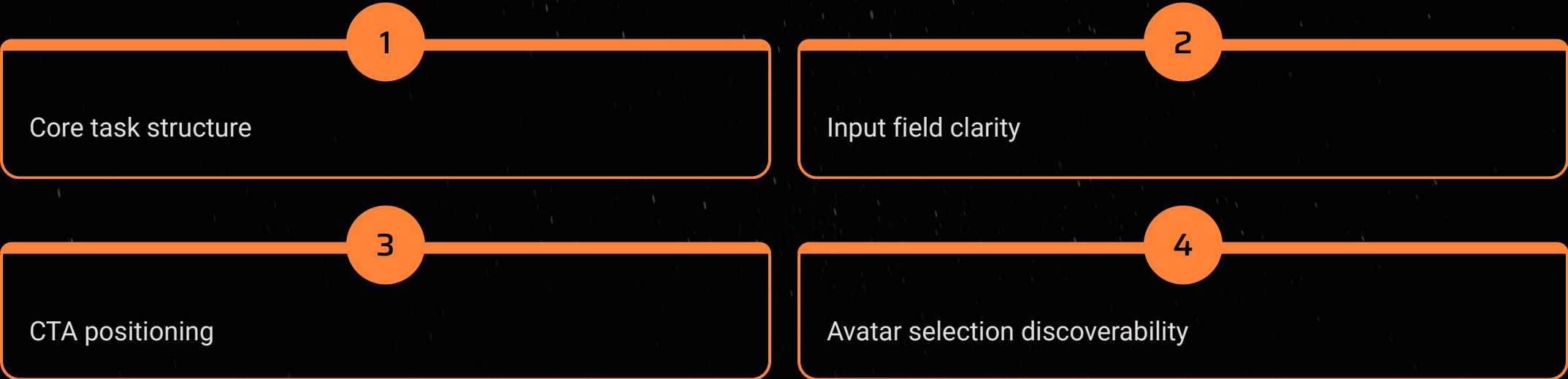
This wireframe represents the first concept for creating a new profile in the interface.

The structure includes essential components: avatar placeholder, name field, Cancel/Next buttons, and a simple modal layout.

The aim was to validate flow logic, input clarity, and the ease of understanding the task before adding advanced visuals.

Usability feedback highlighted the need for more visible avatar options and a clearer hierarchy for the main action button.

Key Focus Areas:



Plugins Used

1

Iconify

Used to import consistent, high-quality icons for navigation, filters, and settings, ensuring visual consistency with Apple's minimal design style.

2

Unsplash

Provided placeholder images during early design stages, helping to visualize layout, spacing, and content density before final assets were added.

3

Local Assets

Manually imported all remaining elements like logos, thumbnails, and UI components, maintaining accuracy with Apple's branding and visual identity.

Design System

Creating a Cohesive Visual Language

COLOR PALETTE (60-30-10 Rule)

Primary (60%):

- **#000000** (Pure Black) - Main background
- **#1C1C1E** (Dark Gray) - Cards & containers

Secondary (30%):

- **#2C2C2E** (Medium Gray) - Secondary elements
- **#F5F5F7** (Off White) - Body text

Accent (10%):

- **#4A90E2** (Blue) - CTAs, highlights
- **#4A90E2** (Blue) - Hover states
- **#4A90E2** (Blue) - Links, info tags

ICONOGRAPHY

Source: Iconify Plugin (Figma)

Icon Sets:

- Lucide Icons - Primary UI icons
- Material Design Icons - Secondary actions
- Heroicons - Navigation elements

Style Guidelines:

- Outlined style for consistency
- 24px × 24px standard size
- 32px × 32px for primary actions
- Monochrome white/orange on dark backgrounds
- 2px stroke width

TYPOGRAPHY

Primary Font: SF Pro Display (Apple System Font)

- H1 (Hero): SF Pro Display Bold, 48px
- H2 (Section Headers): SF Pro Display Semibold, 32px
- H3 (Card Titles): SF Pro Display Medium, 24px
- Body: SF Pro Text Regular, 16px
- Caption: SF Pro Text Regular, 14px

Line Height: 1.5x font size

SCREEN DIMENSIONS & LAYOUT

Desktop: 1728×1117px (MacBook Pro) • 16px margins

LOGO

Apple TV+ Standard Logo

- Minimum size: 120px width
- Clear space: 2× logo height
- Never distort or recolor

The 5 Planes of UX Design

Our approach to enhancing the Apple TV+ user experience is guided by the five planes of UX design, ensuring a holistic and user-centered development process.



Strategy Plane

Focused on improving content discovery, personalization, and ease of navigation for multiple user types (adults, kids).



Scope Plane

Defined core features such as profiles, watchlists, kids-safe modes, and seamless transitions between sections.



Structure Plane

Organized information architecture to support intuitive navigation across Home, Kids, and Watchlist flows.



Skeleton Plane

Wireframes established layout, navigation placement, and interaction patterns without visual distractions.



Surface Plane

Final UI reflects Apple TV's minimal aesthetic while enhancing visual clarity and content emphasis.

AI Integration

Apple TV+ currently provides limited personalization due to the absence of smart recommendations, emotional context recognition, and behavioral adaptation. Users experience *choice overload*, *irrelevant content suggestions*, and *low engagement*. AI integration solves these by learning individual user preferences, predicting content relevance, and dynamically adjusting recommendations across profiles.

How AI Improves UX:

→ **Personalized Discovery**

ML models analyze watch history and preferences to tailor "For You" recommendations

→ **Context-Aware Experience**

AI detects device, time, and past selections to present suitable content (short clips in morning, movies in evening)

→ **Natural Interaction**

Voice/text search enables queries like "Show me a light comedy for kids"

→ **Family Safety**

Classification models flag mature content and maintain age-appropriate profiles



AI Model Design & Data Flow

01

Data Collection

Input data → User behavior logs, viewing time, likes/dislikes, device type, genre tags.

02

Model Training

Apply Collaborative Filtering + Content-Based Recommendation Models. Incorporate Transformer-based Recommender Model (e.g., BERT4Rec or GPT-style fine-tuned model) for sequential viewing prediction.

03

Personalization Layer

Output personalized rankings for each profile. Reinforcement Learning (RL) agent adjusts recommendations based on real-time feedback (e.g., "Watched fully" = reward, "Skipped" = penalty).

04

User Interface Layer

"For You" carousel dynamically updates. Voice AI (e.g., Apple Siri API + GPT-4) interprets natural-language queries.

Example AI Interaction:

User: "Suggest something relaxing for a family night."

AI Model: "Here are three family-friendly comedies trending this week—Paddington 2, Inside Out, and The Mitchells vs. The Machines."

Outcome: Integrating AI transforms Apple TV+ from a static streaming platform into an intelligent, context-aware entertainment ecosystem that continuously learns from user behavior, reducing friction and increasing engagement through tailored, ethical, and adaptive personalization.



Conclusion

The user-experience evaluation of Apple TV+ reveals key deficiencies in **content discovery, navigation efficiency, personalization, and parental control**.

The proposed enhancements directly address these limitations by introducing:

- **Improved filtering and AI-driven recommendations** for faster discovery.
- **Intuitive, reorganized navigation** through card-sorting insights.
- **Distinct user profiles** ensuring personalized experiences.
- **Comprehensive Kids Profile with parental control** for family safety.
- **Streamlined subscription and billing flow** for transparency and simplicity.

📌 Outcome: A personalized, inclusive streaming experience that strengthens engagement and competitive positioning.

Future Enhancements

The future scope outlines potential enhancements beyond the current prototype, focusing on continuous improvement and innovation for the Apple TV+ user experience.



AI-driven Personalized Recommendations

Enhancing content discovery with more sophisticated AI models that predict user preferences and curate unique viewing experiences.



Advanced Parental Control Dashboards

Providing parents with more granular control and insights into their children's viewing habits, ensuring a safer environment.



Multi-device Continuity and Syncing

Seamless transition of viewing experiences across all Apple devices, allowing users to pick up exactly where they left off.



Accessibility Improvements

Implementing voice commands, gesture controls, and adaptive UI features to ensure an inclusive experience for all users.



Data-driven Content Insights

Offering users optional insights into their viewing trends, genre preferences, and time spent on the platform.

These enhancements aim to further improve engagement, inclusivity, and personalization, keeping Apple TV+ at the forefront of streaming innovation.

Explore the Interactive Prototype

Experience the future of Apple TV+ with our interactive Figma prototype. Dive in to navigate through the redesigned interface, test personalized recommendations, and witness the improved user journey we've envisioned.

This prototype brings our vision to life, showcasing how enhanced content discovery, intuitive navigation, and robust parental controls can transform the streaming experience.

[View Prototype](#)

References

The following resources informed the research and design principles applied in this project:

- Garrett, J. J. (2011). The elements of user experience: User-centered design for the web and beyond (2nd ed.). New Riders.
- 8b3c09c0-008a-4af2-b5e0-fbffa1a...
- Nielsen, J. (1994). [10 usability heuristics for user interface design](#). Nielsen Norman Group.
- Apple Inc. (n.d.). [Apple Human Interface Guidelines](#). Apple Developer Documentation.
- Agile Business Consortium. (n.d.). [MoSCoW prioritisation](#).
- Course lecture slides and class materials on user experience design and interaction design.